

ROAMWILD

Building a differentiated
adventure travel brand through
customer intelligence,
positioning and growth strategy

BRAND STRATEGY

CUSTOMER INTELLIGENCE

EXPERIENCE STRATEGY

GROWTH

Amelia Wolfire · 2026

1,500 customers analyzed · 5 segments · competitive whitespace · positioning · experience design · go-to-market · financial model

From a generic adventure brand to a position only ROAMWILD can own

ROAMWILD should stop competing as a better generic adventure company and concentrate on the customer it already serves best: the traveler who wants to be challenged without coming home depleted.

PROBLEM ROAMWILD runs strong trips for everyone, so it has no distinctive reason to be chosen, and it buys most of its growth.	INSIGHT One segment behaves differently: 16% of customers create 42% of lifetime gross profit, with NPS +56 and 47% repeat.	CHOICE Restorative Adventurers first. Purposeful Explorers second. Everyone else served, not chased.
POSITION Own the space between challenge and recovery.	EXPERIENCE Fit Profile, pace-matched groups of ten or fewer, and recovery designed into every day, so the promise (come back challenged and restored) is kept on every trip.	GROWTH THESIS Attract more of the right customer, keep the promise, and let repeat and referral replace paid acquisition.

SCENARIO OUTCOMES, YEAR 1

\$25.6M

REVENUE

+17.2% vs \$21.8M

+\$1.86M

GROSS PROFIT

\$6.76M → \$8.62M

3.85x

CLV : CAC

from 3.37x

5.5 mo

PAYBACK

on \$0.86M incremental investment

THE POSITION CHANGES SIX THINGS

Who the brand targets	What it sells	How the experience works	What it charges	How it goes to market	How it measures success
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The business case is a hypothesis to test, not a guaranteed forecast (page 24).

ROAMWILD's growth problem starts with a lack of strategic focus

DATA

Business model, 1,500-customer sample

SYNTHETIC

ANALYSIS

Unit economics by channel; competitive scoring

INSIGHT

Everything is broad, nothing is ownable

IMPLICATION

Growth is bought, not earned

DECISION

Treat this as a focus problem with a P&L consequence

Broad audience

Five segments, no priority. The best customers are only 16% of new customers.

Broad offering

About 60 itineraries across nine trip types, from surf to cultural immersion.

Generic positioning

Scores 4-6 on every competitive dimension; owns no idea in the category.

Paid acquisition dependence

47% of customers arrive through paid channels, which return ~3x CAC vs 19x for referral.

WEAK DIFFERENTIATION

Customers can't say why ROAMWILD over anyone else

**INEFFICIENT GROWTH**

Every new customer is rented from paid media

CUSTOMERS UNDERSTAND

WHAT ROAMWILD sells.

THEY DO NOT UNDERSTAND

WHY ROAMWILD is the brand to choose.

BASELINE

SYNTHETIC

SCENARIO

Customers / yr

9,987

Revenue

\$21.8M

Avg booking

\$2,151

CAC

\$212

Repeat rate

24.3%

Conversion

0.72%

Gross margin

31%

CLV (5-yr GP)

\$894

CLV : CAC

3.37x

NPS

+11.5

DECISION

Frame the work as a focus problem: decide where to compete, whom to prioritize and what to stand for, then prove the choice in the economics.

Growth requires a choice: where to compete, whom to serve and what to stand for

Where should ROAMWILD compete, who should it prioritize, what should it stand for, and how could that choice create measurable growth?

HOW I APPROACHED IT

01	02	03	04	05	06	07
DIAGNOSE	UNDERSTAND	CHOOSE	POSITION	DESIGN	ACTIVATE	MEASURE
What business and brand problem needs to be solved?	What do customers, competitors and the market tell us?	Where should the brand compete and whom should it prioritize?	What differentiated idea should the brand own?	How must the experience make that promise true?	How should the strategy reach the market?	How do we know it creates customer and business value?

“I built this case to explore how customer and market intelligence can become a differentiated brand position, and how that position can shape the experience, go-to-market strategy and business model.”

WHAT IS REAL, AND WHAT IS NOT

ROAMWILD is fictional An emerging U.S. direct-to-consumer adventure travel company, created for this study.	Customer data is synthetic 1,500 generated customers with documented relationships. SYNTHETIC	Financials are scenarios Projections inform investment decisions; they are not forecasts. SCENARIO	Market research is cited ATTA, Global Wellness Institute, OIA, Booking.com, MMGY. EXTERNAL FACT
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Evidence labels used throughout: EXTERNAL FACT SYNTHETIC ASSUMPTION JUDGMENT SCENARIO RECOMMENDATION

The market is moving toward adventure that restores, but no category clearly owns it

5C	EVIDENCE	STRATEGIC IMPLICATION
Customer	Leisure travelers take 3.6 trips a year; most prefer curated planning (6.3 of 10) SYNTHETIC . Travelers are more selective: 3.5 trips and \$5,570 planned per year MMGY	Win on relevance, not reach: a trip has to earn its place.
Company	Curated operations, a guide network and data on 10,000 customers. Brand strength is concentrated: one segment scores NPS +56 vs +11.5 overall SYNTHETIC	Build on what already works for a specific customer.
Competition	Specialists are known for expertise, wellness companies for rest, planners for exclusivity, marketplaces for price and choice, DIY for freedom JUDGMENT	Respect what each category does well; find a combination no one yet offers.
Collaborators	Guides, lodges and recovery partners deliver the promise; destination organizations, creators and outdoor brands extend reach.	Partners are part of the product, not just distribution.
Context	Wellness tourism grew 13.8% in 2024 GW . Demand favors customized, expert-led adventure ATA . 69% want to leave places better BKG . 52% of travelers now plan with AI MMGY . EXTERNAL FACT	The market is moving toward adventure that restores, and toward being found in AI answers.

WHAT THIS MEANS

ROAMWILD should not try to become a better generic adventure company. It should concentrate around a customer need that is **GROWING, VALUABLE, CREDIBLE FOR THE COMPANY** and **INSUFFICIENTLY OWNED BY COMPETITORS**.

GW Global Wellness Institute (Nov 2025) · ATA Adventure Travel Trade Association (Jun 2025) · BKG Booking.com (Apr 2025) · MMGY MMGY Travel Intelligence, Portrait of American Travelers (Summer 2026). Full citations in Appendix I.

DECISION

Search for the segment and territory where a growing need, high customer value and ROAMWILD's capabilities overlap, rather than competing across all outdoor travel.

Customer value is concentrated, and paid acquisition is not the most efficient source of long-term value

DATA

1,500 customers: CLV, CAC, NPS, repeat, referrals, channels

SYNTHETIC**ANALYSIS**

Distributions, percentiles, cross-tabs, correlations

INSIGHT

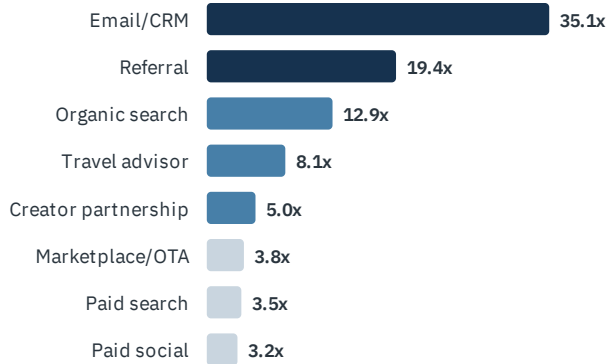
Top 20% of customers hold 55% of lifetime value

IMPLICATION

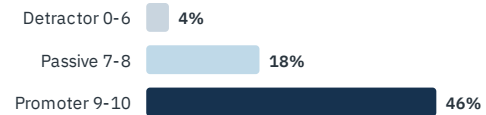
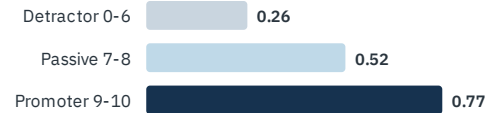
Advocates are the cheapest growth

DECISION

Acquire more of the customers who become advocates

LIFETIME GROSS PROFIT PER \$1 OF ACQUISITION COST

■ Paid (47% of customers) ■ Earned/partner ■ Advocacy + CRM

REPEAT BOOKING RATE BY NPS BAND**REFERRALS PER CUSTOMER BY NPS BAND**

Price sensitivity falls from 7.2 to 3.4 (of 10) from the lowest to highest income quartile. Correlation, not proof of causation.

SATISFACTION

Trips that fit the traveler

**PROMOTION**

Promoters (NPS 9-10)

34% of base

**REPEAT + REFERRAL**

Promoters rebook at 46% vs 3.6%

**LOWER EFFECTIVE ACQUISITION COST**

Referral CAC \$63 vs paid social \$338

**HIGHER CUSTOMER VALUE**

CLV rises with every repeat trip

STRATEGIC IMPLICATION

The goal is not simply to acquire more customers. It is to acquire more of the customers who become valuable advocates, and then design the experience so more of them do.

DECISION

Segment the base by value and advocacy, not demographics, and let the most valuable segment set the brand's priorities.

Five customer segments emerge, with dramatically different economics

k-means clustering on ten standardized needs and behavior variables produced five segments. They differ less in who they are than in what they want from a trip, and that difference shows up directly in the economics.

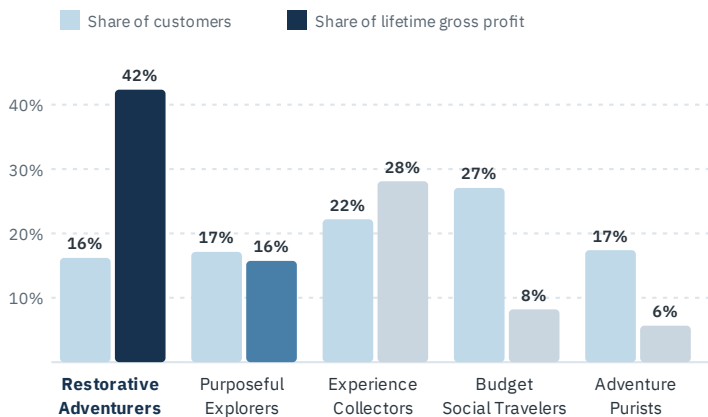
	RESTORATIVE ADVENTURERS	PURPOSEFUL EXPLORERS	EXPERIENCE COLLECTORS	BUDGET SOCIAL TRAVELERS	ADVENTURE PURISTS
Share of customers	16%	17%	22%	27%	17%
Share of lifetime gross profit	42%	16%	28%	8%	6%
NPS	+56	+20	+10	-6	-9
Average CLV	\$3,035	\$1,066	\$1,470	\$352	\$379
CLV : CAC	15.2x	5.9x	6.7x	1.5x	1.9x
Avg booking value	\$3,455	\$1,844	\$3,439	\$1,117	\$1,206
Repeat rate	47%	33%	18%	17%	15%
Stated willingness to pay (premium)	+24%	+14%	+13%	+4%	+4%
Personalization interest (1-10)	8.5	6.0	6.0	4.4	3.7
Wellness interest (1-10)	8.5	6.0	4.6	5.4	3.4
Adventure intensity (1-10)	7.0	6.2	5.6	5.0	8.7
Attractiveness score (8 criteria)	8.16	5.29	5.00	4.27	2.11

k = 5 chosen by silhouette; method, validation and sensitivity in Appendix A.

SYNTHETIC

JUDGMENT

CUSTOMERS VS LIFETIME GROSS PROFIT BY SEGMENT



INSIGHT

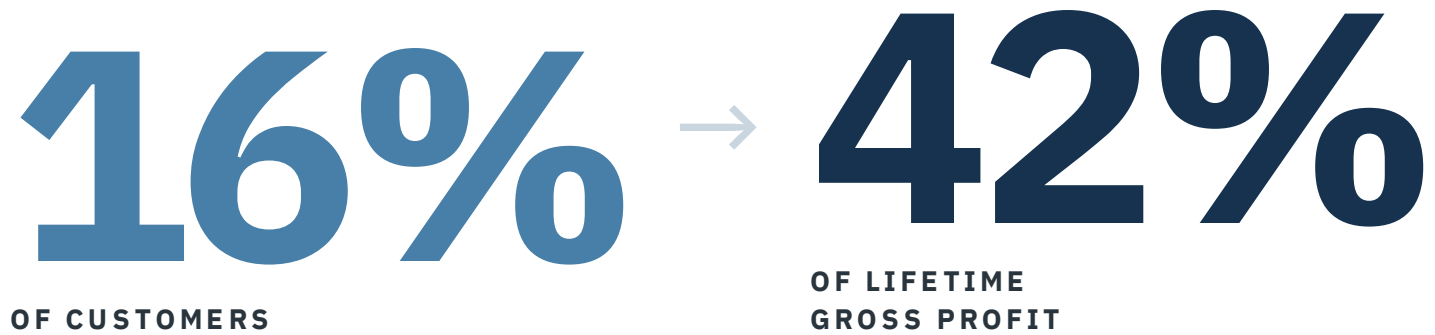
Restorative Adventurers are 16% of customers but 42% of lifetime gross profit. Budget Social Travelers are the largest segment (27%) and among the least valuable (8%).

Purposeful Explorers are the natural adjacency: similar values around community and sustainability, NPS +20, repeat 33%.

DECISION

Stop treating the base as one market. Choose the segment whose value, loyalty and needs ROAMWILD can serve better than anyone.

**16% of customers create
42% of lifetime gross profit**



+56

NPS

vs +11.5 overall

47%

REPEAT

vs 24.3% overall

15.2x

CLV : CAC

vs 3.37x blended

+24%

STATED PREMIUM

willingness to pay

Restorative Adventurers. This customer is different, and the rest of the strategy is built around them.

SYNTHETIC 1,500-customer dataset · lifetime gross profit = 5-year CLV

Concentrate growth around Restorative Adventurers

PRIMARY · INVEST

Restorative Adventurers

Weight acquisition, product and CRM toward them: from 16% to 24% of new customers.

SECONDARY · ADJACENCY

Purposeful Explorers

Shared community and sustainability values. Served through impact departures and organic, community and PR.

MAINTAIN · DON'T CHASE

Collectors, Budget Social, Purists

Core trips stay available; no dedicated spend and no discounting.

WHY RESOURCES SHOULD SHIFT

They are the most valuable

42% of lifetime gross profit; average CLV **\$3,035** vs \$352 for Budget Social.

They will pay for fit

Stated premium **+24%**; a +12% Signature tier sits comfortably inside it.

ROAMWILD can serve them

Curated operations, guides and customer data already fit the need; no new business model required.

They stay and they talk

NPS **+56** and **47%** repeat: the segment most likely to fuel referral.

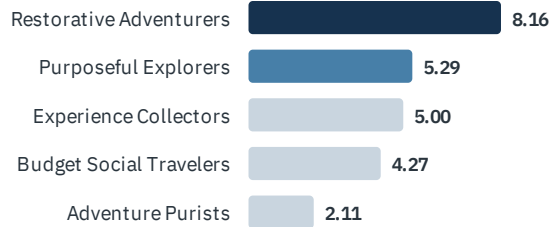
Their need is unowned

No competitor category combines challenge, recovery and personal fit (page 11).

The choice is robust

First under all five weightings tested and in **96%** of 5,000 random weightings.

SEGMENT ATTRACTIVENESS, 8 WEIGHTED CRITERIA (0-10) JUDGMENT



WHAT CHANGES

Targeting stops being a media setting and becomes a business decision: which trips are built, what they cost, who the creative speaks to, and which customers CRM invests in.

DECISION Concentrate growth around Restorative Adventurers, with Purposeful Explorers as the secondary target. Every major investment should be judged by whether it attracts, serves or retains them.

Each competitor category has earned a clear territory. ROAMWILD hasn't claimed one yet.

CATEGORY	TARGET CUSTOMER	VALUE PROPOSITION	EXPERIENCE	WHAT THEY OWN
Traditional tour operators	First-time travelers and those who value certainty	See the highlights without the hassle	Well organized, larger groups	Reassurance
Adventure travel specialists	Active travelers seeking challenge	Go further with experts	Physically demanding, small-to-mid groups	Expertise
Premium travel planners	Affluent, time-poor travelers	A trip built only for you	Private, high-touch	Luxury & exclusivity
Wellness travel companies	Stressed professionals seeking rest	Come back restored	Restful, resort-based	Rest
Travel marketplaces	Value-minded, self-directed travelers	Every option, best price	Self-serve, wide selection	Price & choice
Independent planning	Confident, cost-aware travelers	Your trip, your way	Depends on the traveler	Freedom
ROAMWILD today	Broad: anyone who likes outdoor trips	Curated outdoor trips	Good but inconsistent	Not yet defined

Category archetypes, not individual companies JUDGMENT. Full scoring on eight attributes in Appendix B.

WHERE EACH CATEGORY SCORES HIGH (1-10)

CATEGORY	TRANSFORM.	PERSONAL.	ADVENTURE	COMMUNITY
Tour operators	3	2	3	3
Adventure specialists	6	4	9	6
Premium planners	5	9	4	2
Wellness companies	8	6	3	5
Marketplaces	2	5	5	3
DIY planning	5	6	7	3
ROAMWILD today	5	4	6	5

INSIGHT

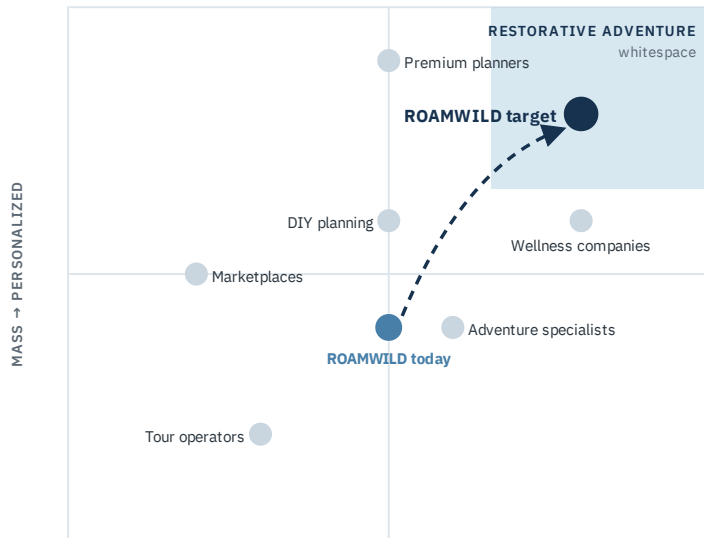
Every category is strong on one or two dimensions. Each serves its customers well. No one yet combines transformation, personalization and adventure, and ROAMWILD today sits in the middle on all three.

These brands have earned their strengths. Rather than compete on their home ground, ROAMWILD should build a distinct offer for a customer none of them is designed around.

DECISION

Don't chase an idea another category has already earned. Look for the combination of benefits the most valuable customer wants and no one yet offers.

The open territory sits between meaningful challenge and genuine recovery



FUNCTIONAL → TRANSFORMATIONAL

■ Competitor categories
 ■ ROAMWILD today
 ■ ROAMWILD target
 ■ Whitespace

THE TERRITORY: RESTORATIVE ADVENTURE

- ✗ Not expedition-grade adventure
- ✗ Not a rest-only retreat
- ✗ Not bespoke luxury

OPPORTUNITY TERRITORIES, WEIGHTED SCORE (0-10)

JUDGMENT

Restorative Adventure	8.55
Impact Expeditions	5.42
Curated Cultural Collections	4.71
Budget Social Trips	3.11
Expedition-Grade Adventure	2.51

Scored on customer desirability, competitive differentiation, business feasibility, brand credibility, revenue potential and defensibility.

WHITESPACE TEST

Distance to the nearest competitor on transformation, personalization and adventure: Restorative Adventure **3.61** vs ROAMWILD today 2.24. Other open spaces exist, but no valuable segment is asking for them.

REAL CHALLENGE

+

REAL RECOVERY

+

PERSONAL FIT

DECISION Move ROAMWILD from a broad, undifferentiated position to Restorative Adventure, the highest-scoring territory (8.55 of 10) and the one its most valuable customers already want.

Choose Restorative Adventure, and build the brand around it

WHO	Restorative Adventurers	16% of customers · 42% of lifetime gross profit · NPS +56
WHERE	Restorative Adventure	The open space between demanding adventure and restorative wellness
WHAT	Come back challenged and restored.	One idea the brand owns
HOW	Fit-matched small groups + challenge/recovery design	Fit Profile · pace-matched groups of ten or fewer · guide pacing and recovery standard
WHY	Higher-value customer economics	Stated premium +24% · repeat 47% · CLV : CAC 15.2x

THE PRINCIPLE

Brand strategy becomes growth strategy when differentiation changes customer behavior and business economics.

The customer doesn't want an easier adventure. They want to feel accomplished without coming home depleted.

CHALLENGE

"I did something difficult."

+

RECOVERY

"I came home better."

=

THE TERRITORY

Restorative Adventure

Strategic articulations of the synthetic customer insight, not verbatim customer quotations.

SYNTHETIC

JUDGMENT

JOBS TO BE DONE

FUNCTIONAL

Give me a meaningful outdoor challenge without forcing me to plan every detail.

EMOTIONAL

Let me feel accomplished, renewed and capable.

SOCIAL

Put me with people who value challenge, health and experience at a similar level.

THE UNMET NEED

MOST ALTERNATIVES FORCE A CHOICE

PUSH HARD or **SLOW DOWN**

Adventure specialists do the first brilliantly; wellness retreats do the second.

ROAMWILD CAN OFFER

**PUSH YOURSELF +
RECOVER INTENTIONALLY**

Fit-matched pacing, with recovery designed into every day.

STRATEGIC IMPLICATION

This is the customer tension behind the Restorative Adventure position. The target is not asking for an easier trip; they are asking for a trip that gives back what it takes.

Own one idea no competitor can claim

Come back challenged and restored.

POSITIONING STATEMENT

FOR time-pressed professionals who want adventure that restores them rather than wears them out, **WHO** need real challenge and real recovery in the same trip without planning it themselves, **ROAMWILD IS** the small-group adventure travel company **THAT** matches every trip to your fitness and balances each day of effort with genuine recovery, **BECAUSE** every itinerary is built from a Fit Profile, paced by guides certified in recovery, and capped at ten travelers.

TARGET AUDIENCE

Restorative Adventurers: time-pressed professionals, median income about \$162K, around 40 years old, who want adventure that leaves them restored (16% of customers, 42% of lifetime gross profit).

FRAME OF REFERENCE

Small-group adventure travel. The competitive set: adventure specialists, wellness retreats and premium travel planners.

CUSTOMER NEED

Come home both challenged and restored, without planning it or trading one for the other.

POINTS OF PARITY

Certified, safety-trained guides; quality lodging; smooth logistics; responsible travel practices; fair cancellation terms.

POINTS OF DIFFERENCE

1) Challenge and recovery designed together. 2) Every trip matched to the traveler's fitness and goals. 3) Small groups of people at the same pace.

REASONS TO BELIEVE

A 12-question Fit Profile and pace groups; guides certified in pacing and recovery; groups capped at ten; recovery included in every itinerary.

WHY THIS IDEA

It is the one benefit the most valuable segment wants, no category owns, and ROAMWILD can prove in the product. Challenge alone belongs to specialists; recovery alone belongs to wellness. The combination is ownable.

The brand platform makes the promise operational, not aspirational

PURPOSE

Help people come back from the outdoors stronger than they left.

MISSION

Design small-group outdoor trips that balance real challenge with real recovery, matched to each traveler.

VALUE PROPOSITION

For Restorative Adventurers: the challenge you want, the recovery you need, planned around you, at a premium that sits below bespoke planners.

Grounded

Capable

Warm

Candid

Curious

VISION

Adventure that leaves people more whole, not more worn out.

PERSONALITY

Grounded, capable, warm, candid, curious.
Never extreme, never pampering.

REASONS TO BELIEVE

Fit Profile and pace groups; recovery-certified guides; groups of ten or fewer; recovery included, never upsold.

HOW THE PLATFORM WORKS

Purpose explains why the brand exists; the promise says what customers get; reasons to believe are operating facts, so the promise can be checked, not just claimed.

BRAND PROMISE

Come back challenged and restored.

Tested on page 24: association with “challenged and restored” is a tracked brand metric.

A position is only a strategy if it forces choices

ROAMWILD WILL

✓ Serve Restorative Adventurers first

24% of new customers by year 1

✓ Match every traveler with a Fit Profile

Fit before booking, not after

✓ Cap every group at ten

Pace-matched, small by design

✓ Include recovery in every itinerary

Part of the price, never an upsell

✓ Charge a premium justified by value

+12% Signature tier, inside EVC headroom of \$730

ROAMWILD WILL NOT

✗ Compete on price for budget group travel

No discounting to win volume

✗ Run groups larger than ten

Even when demand would fill them

✗ Sell expedition-grade technical trips

Specialists already do this well

✗ Sell recovery as an optional add-on

It is the promise, not an extra

✗ Let AI make safety, pricing or positioning decisions

People stay accountable

WHAT WE GIVE UP

67%

of customers (Collectors, Budget Social, Purists) lose dedicated spend. They still book core trips, but they hold only 42% of lifetime gross profit. Saying no to them is what makes the yes credible.

The position only works if the experience makes it true

STAGE	CUSTOMER NEED	BRAND PROMISE	INTERVENTION	KPI
Discover	See trips for someone like me	Challenge and recovery, matched to you	Stories from real travelers showing both halves of the day	Target reach; CTR
Explore	Compare trips at my level	Fit first	Honest effort and recovery ratings on every trip	Trip page → Fit Profile start
Fit	Know it fits me	Fit first	12-question Fit Profile and pace-group match	Completion 55%
Book	Confidence, fair terms	Recovery included, never upsold	Transparent Signature pricing showing what recovery includes	Conversion 0.76%
Prepare	Be ready	Effort earns rest	Four-week prep plan by pace group; guide intro call	Prep plan opened 70%
Experience	Challenge plus recovery, with my people	Challenged and restored	Guide pacing standard; daily check-ins; groups of ten or fewer	Pacing complaints < 5%
Reflect	Make sense of it	Come back stronger	Recovery recap and progress summary	Target NPS +50 or higher
Return	Next challenge	Fit first	Next trip based on Fit Profile progress	Cohort repeat 29%
Advocate	Share it	Small by design	Alumni community; referral credit for pace-matched friends	Referral share 20%

THREE PRIORITY CHANGES

01

Fit Profile

Matches every traveler to a trip and a level before they book. Proves "fit first."

02

Pace-matched groups

Ten or fewer, grouped by pace. Proves "small by design" and removes the #1 pain.

03

Guide pacing + recovery standard

Certification and a set ratio of effort to recovery days. Proves "challenged and restored."

OPERATING PROOF

These are not random product features. They are the operating proof of the positioning: remove any one and the promise stops being true.

Use AI to strengthen the strategy, not to become the strategy

BUSINESS PROBLEM



STRATEGY



PROCESS



THEN TECHNOLOGY

AI → find something to automate

AI augmentation

Makes the promise scalable and personal

Fit Profile matching

Fit first

Trip recommendations

Fit first

Group-matching suggestions

Small by design

Content personalization

Right story, right segment

Sentiment analysis

Catch promise breaks

Retention prediction

Come back stronger

Customer-service assistance

Fast answers, human hand-off

Human decision rights

Where judgment, accountability and the brand live

Brand positioning

Strategy

Pricing strategy

Value capture

Safety

Non-negotiable

Guide decisions in the field

Experience

Experience standards

The promise

Customer escalation

Trust

Strategic trade-offs

What we say no to

DECISION LEVELS FOR ANY AI SYSTEM

Observe

Gathers and summarizes signals

Recommend

Suggests an action with evidence and confidence

Test

Proposes a controlled experiment within limits

Human decision

Positioning, pricing, promise, policy, safety

EXAMPLE

A brand intelligence agent notices pacing complaints in the target segment rising from 10% to 27% of reviews. It flags the break in the promise and proposes a test; a person decides what changes on the trip.

Working prototype and governance: Appendix H and the repository.

Earn the Rest turns the position into a campaign idea

CUSTOMER INSIGHT

Torn between trips that wreck them and trips that bore them

TARGET

Restorative Adventurers

POSITION

The space between challenge and recovery

BRAND PROMISE

Come back challenged and restored

CAMPAIGN PLATFORM

Earn the Rest: make the recovery feel earned

EARN THE REST.

Come back challenged and restored.

Every hard day is matched with real recovery. The campaign shows both halves of the day and makes the rest feel earned, which is exactly the tension the target lives with.

AWARENESS

“Hard day. Hot spring. Repeat.”

Show both halves of the day

CONSIDERATION

“Your pace. Your people. Ten max.”

Prove it fits me

BOOKING

“Recovery included.”

Remove the risk

RETENTION

“You're ready for the next level.”

Show progress

ONE PLATFORM · 12 MONTHS

Channels adapt the expression. None of them changes the promise.

The idea becomes visible in a few disciplined executions

CUSTOMER INSIGHT

Challenge without depletion

POSITIONING

Come back challenged and restored

CAMPAIGN PLATFORM

Earn the Rest

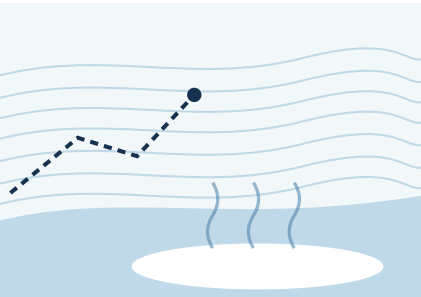
CREATIVE EXPRESSION

Both halves of the day, in every asset

STRATEGY → EXPRESSION


ROAMWILD
Sponsored

Five days in the Eastern Sierra, paced to your fitness. Every summit day ends in real recovery.



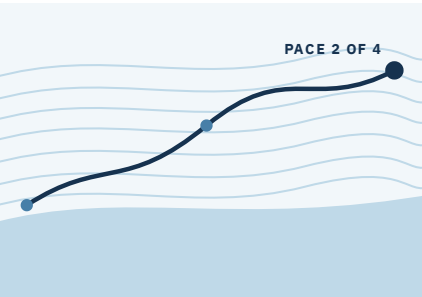
Hard day. Hot spring. Repeat.

[Find your fit](#)

Paid social · 4:5 · Awareness · Restorative Adventurers


ROAMWILD
Sponsored

Answer 12 questions and we'll match you to a trip and a group that moves like you do.



Your pace. Your people. Ten max.

[Take the Fit Profile](#)

Paid social · 4:5 · Consideration · Restorative Adventurers (retargeting)


ROAMWILD
Sponsored

Impact departures with local stewardship crews. Leave the trail better than you found it.



Summit in the morning. Trail work in the afternoon.

[See impact trips](#)

Paid social · 4:5 · Secondary · Purposeful Explorers

SEARCH · RESPONSIVE AD

Small-Group Adventure Trips | Recovery Built Into Every Day | Matched To Your Fitness

Hike hard, recover well. Groups of 10 or fewer, paced by certified guides. Take the 3-minute Fit Profile.

CREATIVE RULES THAT PROTECT THE POSITION

- Every asset shows effort and recovery together.
- Real travelers and guides, ages 35-55; no pro athletes, no staged summits.
- One proof point per asset: fit, recovery or group size.

Concept executions for a fictional brand; abstract illustrations stand in for photography of effort → recovery (trail ascent → hot spring, movement → stillness).

RECOMMENDATION

One positioning idea travels across content, creators, PR and partners

The same idea has to hold up whether it appears in a creator's video, a press headline or a partner's lodge. Each channel carries one part of the promise.

CONTENT

Stories that show both halves of the day

Four pillars led by Challenged & Restored (40%); SEO and AI-search guides answer “how hard is this trip?”

Traces to: **challenge + recovery** · KPI: Saves, shares, Fit Profile starts

CREATORS

Honest effort, not staged summits

Mid-size hiking and wellness creators (20K-200K) paired with a guide; one real hard section and one recovery moment in every piece; disclosed.

Traces to: **people like me** · KPI: Cost per Fit Profile start

PR

The Restorative Travel Report

Annual survey of 2,000 U.S. leisure travelers on burnout, recovery and adventure, released with the Signature launch. Headlines stay “[X]” until fielded.

Traces to: **owning the idea** · KPI: Earned placements; citations in AI answers

DESTINATION PARTNERSHIPS

Co-op with tourism boards

Shared film shoots and shoulder-season departures in three launch regions, spreading visitors beyond peak weeks.

Traces to: **leave it better** · KPI: Co-op reach; partner-referred bookings

RECOVERY PARTNERS

Recovery that is real, not a spa add-on

Lodges, hot springs, physiotherapists and massage partners certified to the ROAMWILD recovery standard.

Traces to: **recovery built in** · KPI: Recovery satisfaction 4.5

OUTDOOR PARTNERS

Gear that makes the effort easier

Outdoor brands supply a gear library and co-create prep content; event-led “Earn the Rest Weekends” create waitlists without discounts.

Traces to: **fit first** · KPI: Partner reach; waitlist sign-ups

CONTENT PILLARS, SHARE OF OUTPUT

Challenged & Restored 40%

Fit & Pace 25%

Guides & Recovery 20%

Leave It Better 15%

Why earned and partner channels matter: MMGY finds 55% of travelers interested in event-tied trips^{MMGY}, and every earned story is also a source AI assistants can cite when travelers ask where to go.

DECISION

Build the brand through partners and earned stories, not just paid reach: owned and earned channels grow from 35% to 38% of new customers.

Full 13-week content calendar, creator brief and earned plan: Appendix F.

The growth model shifts from buying attention to building customer value



LIFECYCLE JOURNEYS THAT TURN THE CHAIN

ASSUMPTION

JOURNEY	TRIGGER	TARGET
Fit Profile welcome	Email captured, profile not started	Profile start 30%
Fit Profile abandon	Profile started, not finished	Completion 55%
4-week prep plan	30 days before departure	Plan opened 70%
Daily check-in	During trip	Pulse reply 50%
Recap + NPS + review	Trip end	NPS response 45%
Next-level invite	90 days after trip	Rebook 29% (cohort)
Referral ask	NPS 9-10 only	Referral share 20%
Win-back	12 months lapsed or high churn score	Reactivation 6%

8 of 11 triggered journeys, personalized with Fit Profile data. All 11: Appendix G.

WHY THIS MATTERS
Each step is a measurable hypothesis. If one link fails (NPS rises but repeat does not), the measurement system shows exactly where, before more money follows.

THE SHIFT
Paid media stops being the engine and becomes the starter: 47% of customers arrive through paid today; the target mix leans on repeat, referral and partners.

Strategy case vs baseline SCENARIO; Fit Profile, pacing and NPS targets ASSUMPTION. Links are causal hypotheses to be tested, not proven effects.

Go-to-market is a business strategy, not a media calendar

PRODUCT Signature Restorative tier 10 itineraries with recovery designed into every day; core trips rebuilt with honest effort ratings; impact departures for the secondary target. KPI · Signature share of target bookings 60%	PRICE Premium justified by value +12% Signature tier, below stated willingness to pay (+24%) and EVC headroom (\$730); no discounting. KPI · Booking value \$2,151 → \$2,422	PLACE Direct first, partners for proof Direct booking built around the Fit Profile; destination and recovery partners on the ground; advisors for private departures; less marketplace reliance. KPI · Owned + earned 35% → 38% of new customers
PROMOTION The Earn the Rest ecosystem One platform across content, creators, PR, paid and owned media; positioning-led creative replaces generic trip ads. KPI · Positioning-led CTR +25% vs generic (test)	PARTNERSHIPS Part of the product DMOs (co-op, shoulder season), lodges, recovery partners, creators, outdoor brands (gear library). KPI · Partner-referred bookings; co-op reach	CRM Lifecycle from Fit Profile to advocacy 11 triggered journeys personalized by Fit Profile data; next-level invites; referral credit for promoters only. KPI · Cohort repeat 24.3% → 29.0%

THE INVESTMENT

SCENARIO

\$2.41M

MARKETING INVESTMENT

from \$2.00M today

\$0.86M

INCREMENTAL

incl. \$450K one-off for Fit Profile, certification, tracker

116%

MARKETING ROI, YEAR 1

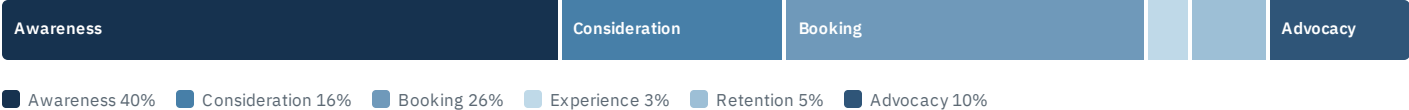
+\$1.86M gross profit

\$199

ACQUISITION CAC

from \$212, falling while brand spend rises

WHERE THE \$2.41M GOES, BY FUNNEL STAGE



DECISION

Fund the strategy, not the channels: shift growth toward owned, earned and partner routes while holding paid social flat. Acquisition CAC falls from \$212 to \$199 even as brand investment more than doubles.

Channel-level media plan: Appendix E.

The strategy earns the right to scale through evidence

Brand metrics

Does the market see us differently?

Association with 'challenged + restored'
— → **35%**

Consideration (target)
18% → 24%

AI answer visibility (25 prompts)
0% → 20%

Customer behavior

Do customers act differently?

Fit Profile completion
— → **55%**

Repeat, new cohort
24.3% → 29.0%

Referral share of new
14.9% → 20%

Commercial outcomes

Does it pay?

CLV : CAC
3.37 → 3.85

Gross margin
31.0% → 33.7%

Revenue
\$21.8M → \$25.6M

EVIDENCE GATE

Scale in Q3 only if:

TARGET SHARE

≥ 20%

of new customers

SIGNATURE ADOPTION

≥ 50%

of target bookings

PACING COMPLAINTS

< 5%

target segment

ACQUISITION CAC

≤ \$212

today's level or better

PASS → SCALE

Alumni community, referral, creator scale-up, geo holdout

FAIL → LEARN + REFINE

Fix the broken link in the chain before more money follows

The model does not promise a result. It tells management what has to be true, and how early we can find out.

FINANCIAL CASE, YEAR 1 SCENARIO

	BASELINE	TARGET	CHANGE
Target share of new customers	16%	24%	+8 pts
CLV, new customer	\$894	\$1,223	+36.9%
Revenue	\$21.82M	\$25.57M	+17.2%
Gross profit	\$6.76M	\$8.62M	+27.5%
Marketing investment	\$2.00M	\$2.41M	+20.4%

BEFORE THE GATE: Q1-Q2

Build Fit Profile and guide certification, run tracker wave 1, pilot 10 Signature itineraries, and A/B test message and price framing.

STRESS TEST

Every single downside still pays back in 6-8 months; all four together turn year-1 ROI to -46%. That is why the gate exists.

SYNTHETIC segment economics · ASSUMPTION inputs · EXTERNAL FACT market context. ROI 116%, payback 5.5 months. Appendix D.

From customer insight to brand growth

“I created ROAMWILD to explore how an emerging travel brand could turn customer intelligence into a differentiated market position, then carry that choice through the customer experience, go-to-market strategy and financial model.”

Brand strategy

- Market definition
- Segmentation
- Targeting
- Positioning
- Brand platform
- Trade-offs

Chose one segment and one idea, and said no to the rest.

Customer + market intelligence

- Customer analysis
- Behavioral segmentation
- Competitive mapping
- Willingness to pay
- Market research

Built and analyzed a 1,500-customer dataset; cited current travel research.

Business + growth strategy

- CAC
- CLV
- Pricing
- Channel economics
- Scenario modeling
- Measurement

Built a 23-sheet decision model connecting customer mix, pricing, acquisition, retention and brand investment to revenue and gross profit.

23 sheets · 1,476 formulas · zero errors

Emerging technology

- Personalization
- AI-assisted journeys
- Decision rights
- Experimentation
- Human oversight

Started with the business and customer problem; used AI only where it strengthens the promise.

MY FOCUS

I'm interested in the point where customer understanding becomes a strategic choice,

where a brand decides who it is for, what it will own, how it will deliver that promise, and how that differentiation can create measurable growth.

AMELIA WOLFIRE

Brand Strategy · Customer Intelligence · Growth Strategy

Travel · Hospitality · Outdoor · Lifestyle

Segmentation method, validation and sensitivity

Variables (standardized): travel frequency, log annual travel spend, adventure intensity, wellness interest, sustainability importance, community interest, price sensitivity, luxury preference, personalization interest, cultural interest. k-means for k = 4, 5, 6; silhouette 0.219 / 0.226 / 0.212 → k = 5. Because the data is synthetic, segments were checked against the generating profiles: adjusted Rand index 0.746. Modest silhouettes are typical of attitudinal data; real survey data may be fuzzier.

ATTRACTIVENESS SCORES (1-10)

CRITERION	WEIGHT	RESTORATIVE	PURPOSEFUL	EXPERIENCE	BUDGET	ADVENTURE
Market size	15%	1.0	1.8	6.0	10.0	2.0
Growth potential JUDGMENT	15%	9.0	7.0	6.0	6.0	4.0
Willingness to pay	15%	10.0	5.3	5.0	1.0	1.1
Customer lifetime value	15%	10.0	3.4	4.8	1.0	1.1
Brand fit	15%	10.0	6.4	7.0	7.8	1.0
Retention potential	10%	10.0	6.2	1.9	1.6	1.0
Competitive whitespace JUDGMENT	10%	8.0	6.0	3.0	2.0	3.0
Accessibility	5%	7.1	10.0	3.9	1.0	6.6

Data-driven criteria are min-max scaled from segment profiles; growth potential and whitespace are analyst judgments with cited rationale (e.g., wellness tourism +13.8% in 2024, GWI).

RANK UNDER FIVE WEIGHTINGS

WEIGHTING	RESTORATIVE	PURPOSEFUL	EXPERIENCE	BUDGET	ADVENTURE
Base (brief)	#1	#2	#3	#4	#5
Economics-led	#1	#2	#3	#4	#5
Growth-led	#1	#4	#3	#2	#5
Equal weights	#1	#2	#3	#4	#5
Differentiation-led	#1	#2	#3	#4	#5

ROBUSTNESS

Across 5,000 random weight sets, Restorative Adventurers rank first in **96.3%**; Purposeful Explorers rank second in **81.6%**. The choice does not depend on one set of weights.

Full 5C evidence and competitive scoring

CUSTOMER	COMPANY	COMPETITION	COLLABORATORS	CONTEXT
- Travel 3.6 times a year and spend about \$10,700 on leisure travel (SYNTHETIC). - Average ROAMWILD booking is \$2,151; the median is \$1,730 (SYNTHETIC). - Most prefer curated planning (6.3 of 10) over doing it themselves (SYNTHETIC). - Barriers: planning time, uncertainty about fitness level, and price for lower-income travelers.	- Strengths: curated operations, a contracted guide network, and trip data on 10,000 customers. - Brand strength is concentrated: Restorative Adventurers give it an NPS of +56, versus +11.5 overall (SYNTHETIC). - Weaknesses: generic positioning, a catalog built for everyone, dependence on paid media. - Technology: booking site and basic CRM; no personalization or brand tracking yet.	- Direct: adventure travel specialists. - Indirect: wellness travel companies, premium travel planners, traditional tour operators. - Substitutes: marketplaces and independent planning, now helped by AI tools. - Each category has earned one clear idea (expertise, rest, exclusivity, price, freedom). ROAMWILD has not claimed one yet.	- Guides and outfitters deliver the product and the promise. - Lodges and recovery partners (spas, physiotherapists) can make recovery real. - Tourism organizations, airlines and outdoor brands extend reach. - Creators and alumni carry credibility that paid ads cannot.	- Wellness tourism grew 13.8% in 2024 [GWI]. - Adventure demand favors customized, expert-led trips; median \$3,000 for 8 nights [ATTA]. - Record outdoor participation, but people go out less often [OIA]. 69% of travelers want to leave places better; 73% want spending to reach locals [BKG].

COMPETITIVE MATRIX

JUDGMENT

CATEGORY	VALUE PROPOSITION	PRICE	CURATION	TRANSFORM.	ADVENTURE	PERSONAL.	COMMUNITY	SUSTAIN.	DIGITAL
Traditional tour operators	See the highlights without the hassle	4	9	3	3	2	3	4	4
Adventure travel specialists	Go further with experts	6	7	6	9	4	6	7	5
Premium travel planners	A trip built only for you	9	9	5	4	9	2	5	5
Wellness travel companies	Come back restored	8	8	8	3	6	5	6	5
Travel marketplaces	Every option, best price	3	2	2	5	5	3	3	9
Independent planning	Your trip, your way	2	1	5	7	6	3	4	8
ROAMWILD today	Curated outdoor trips	5	7	5	6	4	5	5	6

Category archetypes scored 1-10; no individual company is rated. Scores describe fit with this target customer, not quality: each archetype serves its own customers well. Replace with a formal audit before external use.

OPPORTUNITY TERRITORIES (WEIGHTS 20/20/15/15/20/10)

TERRITORY	DESIRABILITY	DIFFERENTIATION	FEASIBILITY	CREDIBILITY	POTENTIAL	DEFENSIBILITY	SCORE
Restorative Adventure	10.0	8.0	7.0	8.0	10.0	7.0	8.55
Impact Expeditions	5.1	6.0	6.0	6.0	3.5	7.0	5.42
Curated Cultural Collections	4.3	3.0	6.0	5.0	6.5	3.0	4.71
Budget Social Trips	1.2	2.0	8.0	5.0	1.6	2.0	3.11
Expedition-Grade Adventure	1.1	3.0	5.0	3.0	1.0	3.0	2.51

Willingness-to-pay, economic value and the customer value chain

FROM NEED TO VALUE



PAINS

- Trips are either too hard (no recovery) or too soft (no challenge)
- Difficulty ratings are vague
- Planning takes 10+ hours
- Mismatched groups slow everyone down

GAINS

- The right level of challenge
- Recovery built in, not sold as extras
- A group at my pace
- Everything handled

UNMET NEEDS

- Fitness-matched pacing
- Recovery as part of the itinerary
- Honest effort ratings

Stated willingness to pay overstates real behavior, so a customer counts as a likely Signature adopter only if their stated premium is at least 1.5 times the 12% price premium **ASSUMPTION**. The premium flows to margin after 35% is spent delivering it (extra guide time, recovery partners, matching).

SEGMENT	BOOKING VALUE	STATED PREMIUM	LIKELY SIGNATURE ADOPTERS	BOOKING VALUE UPLIFT	MARGIN WITH SIGNATURE
Restorative Adventurers	\$3,455	23.7%	81%	9.7%	36.6%
Purposeful Explorers	\$1,844	13.6%	21%	2.6%	32.5%
Experience Collectors	\$3,439	13.0%	18%	2.2%	32.3%
Budget Social Travelers	\$1,117	4.3%	0%	0.0%	31.0%
Adventure Purists	\$1,206	4.5%	2%	0.3%	31.2%

EVC BUILD, 5-NIGHT TRIP, PER TRAVELER **ASSUMPTION**

Lodging, 5 nights at \$330	\$1,650
Private guide, 3 days at \$350	\$1,050
Recovery sessions (massage, sauna, yoga)	\$450
Ground transport and logistics	\$300
Planning time, 12 hours at \$75/hour	\$900
Reference value (do it yourself)	\$4,350
+ Fitness-matched pacing and route choice	\$250
+ Small-group community (max 10)	\$200
– Less schedule flexibility than DIY	\$-200
Economic value to the customer	\$4,600
Signature price (+12%)	\$3,870
Headroom	\$730

WHY +12%

It sits well below the target's mean stated premium (+24%) and leaves \$730 of economic value with the customer, so the price feels fair while still lifting target booking value 9.7% and margin to 36.6%.

Financial model: assumptions, scenarios and stress tests

KEY INPUTS

ASSUMPTION

GROSS MARGIN TODAY	31%
PRIOR-YEAR CUSTOMERS	10,000
SESSIONS (BASE / STRATEGY / UPSIDE)	1.05M / 1.00M / 1.06M
CONVERSION	0.72% / 0.76% / 0.82%
ACQUISITION EFFICIENCY	0 / 5% / 10%
REPEAT UPLIFT	0 / +2 pts / +4 pts
BRAND INVESTMENT	\$400K / \$900K / \$1.0M
ONE-OFF STRATEGIC INVESTMENT	\$0 / \$450K / \$450K
TARGET SHARE OF NEW CUSTOMERS	16% / 24% / 30%
CLV	5-year gross profit, undiscounted

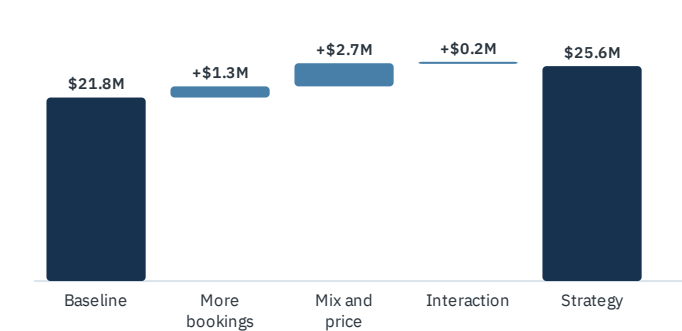
STRESS TESTS

SCENARIO

CASE	REVENUE GROWTH	INCREMENTAL GP	MARKETING ROI	PAYBACK (MO)
Strategy case as modeled	17.2%	\$1.86M	116%	5.5
No conversion lift (0.72%)	12.4%	\$1.51M	94%	6.2
Half the premium-tier adoption	14.7%	\$1.33M	55%	7.7
Target reaches only 20% of new customers	10.7%	\$1.33M	52%	7.9
No repeat-rate uplift	15.1%	\$1.71M	99%	6.0
All four downsides at once	2.2%	\$0.42M	-46%	22.4
Upside case	43.3%	\$3.89M	264%	3.3

Mechanism: new customers = sessions × conversion; the new-customer mix shifts toward the target; booking value and margin rise only for likely Signature adopters; returning customers come from a 10,000-customer base. Every figure recalculates in the workbook (14_FINANCIAL_MODEL, 15_SCENARIO_ANALYSIS).

REVENUE BRIDGE, BASELINE TO STRATEGY



About 73% of growth comes from selling to more valuable customers at a slightly higher price, not more volume.

Channel-level media plan

LINE	STAGE	BUDGET	NEW CUSTOMERS	CONVERSION	IMPLIED CAC	BASELINE CAC
Paid social · prospecting	Awareness	\$363K	1,064	0.35%	\$342	\$338
Paid social · retargeting	Consideration	\$151K	532	0.66%	\$285	\$338
Paid search (brand + non-brand)	Booking	\$394K	1,368	1.24%	\$288	\$294
Creator partnerships	Awareness	\$242K	988	0.71%	\$245	\$215
Travel advisor commissions	Booking	\$136K	456	4.56%	\$299	\$231
Marketplace / OTA fees	Booking	\$91K	304	1.01%	\$299	\$297
Referral credits	Advocacy	\$136K	1,216	2.43%	\$112	\$63
Organic content, SEO & AI search	Consideration	\$234K	1,216	0.55%		
Lifecycle & CRM (platform, content, SMS)	Retention	\$126K	456	0.76%		
Brand film & creative production	Awareness	\$162K				
PR, media & advisor trips	Awareness	\$108K				
Community & alumni events	Advocacy	\$108K				
Prep & recovery experience content	Experience	\$72K				
Brand tracking & testing tools	Awareness	\$90K				

Budget pools, new customers (7,600) and blended conversion (0.76%) reconcile exactly to the financial model (checks on 13A_MEDIA_PLAN). Spend peaks April-June for the Signature launch. Referral CAC rises because the credit increases to \$150; it remains the cheapest route to the target.

ASSUMPTION

SCENARIO

Content calendar, earned media and creator program

WK	SHORT VIDEO (IG/TIKTOK)	YOUTUBE / LONG FORM	SEO & AI-SEARCH GUIDES	EMAIL NEWSLETTER	CREATORS & PR
W1	Teaser: 'the other half of the day'	-	How hard is a 'moderate' hike?	Launch teaser	-
W2	Guide intro: Maya on pacing	-	Choosing your fitness level	Fit Profile invite	Creator trip 1 (Sierra)
W3	Hard day / hot spring split cut	Brand film (3 min)	Recovery days explained	Story: first summit	-
W4	Fit Profile in 30 seconds	-	Best recovery-focused hiking trips	Signature preview	PR: Signature launch
W5	LAUNCH: Earn the Rest	Film cut-downs	Signature trip pages live	LAUNCH email	Creator posts go live
W6	Traveler story: Dana, 41	-	4-week prep plan	Prep plan series	-
W7	Guide tip: pace breathing	Guide Q&A	Small-group vs solo trips	Story: pace groups	Creator trip 2 (Utah)
W8	Recovery partner spotlight	-	Hot springs trips guide	Alumni offer	Podcast guest spot
W9	UGC week: alumni clips	-	Effort ratings, honestly	Story: impact trip	Impact partner PR
W10	Trail work day (impact)	Impact mini-doc	Leave-no-trace trip guide	Impact departures	-
W11	Myth: rest is lazy	-	What 'restorative' really means	Referral push	Creator trip 3 (Montana)
W12	Fit Profile results reveal	Guide Q&A	Summer trips by fitness	Summer lineup	-
W13	Quarter recap + next level	-	FAQ refresh for AI answers	Next-level invites	Q3 creator roster

PROPRIETARY RESEARCH → PR
The Restorative Travel Report
An annual survey of 2,000 U.S. leisure travelers on burnout, recovery and adventure, fielded in Q1 and released with the Signature launch.

DMO PARTNERSHIPS
Destination co-op campaigns
Co-funded content with tourism boards in three launch regions: shared film shoots, placement in visitor guides and newsletters, and shoulder-season departures that spread visitors beyond peak weeks.

EXPERIENCE MARKETING
Event-led departures
Limited 'Earn the Rest Weekends' built around dark-sky festivals, fall color and park anniversaries, answering the 55% of travelers interested in event-tied trips.

Content pillars: Challenged & Restored (40%), Fit & Pace (25%), Guides & Recovery (20%), Leave It Better (15%). Creator brief, video scripts and the full earned plan are on 13D_CONTENT_CALENDAR. The Restorative Travel Report headlines use placeholders until the survey is fielded.

Lifecycle journeys and test plan

CRM JOURNEYS

ASSUMPTION

FLOW	TRIGGER	CHANNEL · TIMING	TARGET
Fit Profile welcome	Email captured, profile not started	Email · 0 h, day 2, day 5	Profile start 30%
Fit Profile abandon	Profile started, not finished	Email + retargeting · 1 h, day 1	Completion 55%
Matched-trip follow-up	Profile complete, no booking in 3 days	Email · Day 3, day 7	Profile-to-booking 12%
Browse abandon	Viewed a trip twice, no checkout	Email · Day 1	Click 6%
Booking + guide intro	Booking confirmed	Email + SMS · 0 h, day 2	Guide-call booked 60%
4-week prep plan	30 days before departure	Email + app · Weekly x4	Plan opened 70%
Daily check-in	During trip	SMS · Each evening	Pulse reply 50%
Recap + NPS + review	Trip end	Email · Day 1, day 4	NPS response 45%
Next-level invite	90 days after trip	Email · Day 90	Rebook 29% (cohort)
Referral ask	NPS 9-10 only	Email · Day 7 after NPS	Referral share 20%
Win-back	12 months lapsed or high churn score	Email · Monthly x3	Reactivation 6%

A/B TESTS · 80% POWER, 5% SIGNIFICANCE

TEST	BASELINE → TARGET	SAMPLE PER ARM	WEEKS	VERDICT
Positioning vs generic ad	1.2% → 1.5%	23,228	2	Run
Fit Profile on trip pages	2.0% → 2.4%	21,109	5	Run as a quarter-long test
Recovery-included price framing	40.0% → 48.0%	604	13	Run as a quarter-long test
Progress vs promo email	3.0% → 3.6%	13,914	2	Run
Referral credit \$150 vs \$100	8.0% → 12.0%	882	27	Underpowered: test a bigger change or run as a holdout

Incrementality: paid social geo holdout (Q3), creator lift study, branded search lift, light marketing mix model from Q4. AI search visibility tracked monthly across 25 prompts in the assistants travelers use most (ChatGPT, Gemini)^{MMGY}.

Brand intelligence agent and AI governance

A runnable prototype (models/brand_intelligence_agent.py) collects, classifies, detects patterns, compares against a baseline, flags anomalies, assesses confidence and recommends actions. Decision rights are enforced in code: anything touching positioning, pricing, major campaigns, the brand promise, customer policy or safety escalates to a person, whatever the model's confidence.

SAMPLE RUN ON SYNTHETIC SIGNALS

SYNTHETIC

OUTPUT	FINDING	DECISION LEVEL
Brand risk	Negative pacing mentions rose from 10% to 27% of reviews (weeks 21-26 vs 1-18).	Test
Customer insight	Weekly NPS moved from +56 to +42.	Recommend
Segment shift	Weekly bookings up 38% versus baseline.	Recommend
Emerging trend	Search interest in 'recovery hiking trip' up 39% over 26 weeks.	Recommend
Growth opportunity	Positioning-led message CTR 2.04% vs generic 1.22% (+68%).	Test
Competitive signal	A leading wellness travel company launched 'active retreats' with guided hiking (week 23).	Human decision
Customer insight	27% of reviews mention price or value.	Observe

GUARDRAILS

- Confidence shown with every insight; low-confidence insights cannot trigger tests.
- Human-only areas are hard-coded: positioning, pricing, major campaigns, brand promise, customer policy.
- Every recommendation and decision is logged with its evidence.
- Monthly review of false positives and missed signals.
- Customer data used under consent; no sensitive health data without opt-in.
- One named owner can pause the agent at any time.

Sources, evidence labels and limitations

EXTERNAL FACTS

- 1. **Adventure Travel Trade Association**, 2025 Adventure Travel Trends & Insights Report (press release), 2025-06-24. Median adventure trip price was \$3,000 for an eight-night itinerary; 73% of operators reported revenue growth; demand is strong for customized, expert-led trips. <https://www.adventuretravelnews.com/atta-releases-2025-annual-adventure-travel-trends-insights-report> · accessed 2026-09-26
- 2. **Global Wellness Institute**, Global Wellness Economy Monitor press release, 2025-11-19. Wellness tourism grew 13.8% from 2023 to 2024; mental wellness and wellness tourism are forecast to grow 9.1% a year through 2029; the global wellness economy reached \$6.8 trillion in 2024. <https://globalwellnessinstitute.org/press-room/press-releases/the-global-wellness-economy-hits-a-record-6-8-trillion-and-is-forecast-to-reach-9-8-trillion-by-2029/> · accessed 2026-09-26
- 3. **Outdoor Industry Association**, 2026 Outdoor Participation Trends Report (release), 2026-06-16. A record 183.2 million Americans (59% of those 6+) participated in outdoor recreation in 2025, but Americans go outside less often than before the pandemic; growth now depends on building lasting habits. <https://www.outdoorsportswire.com/outdoor-recreation-participation-reaches-record-183-2-million-americans-according-to-new-outdoor-industry-association-report/> · accessed 2026-09-26
- 4. **Booking.com**, 2025 Travel & Sustainability research, 2025-04-22. 69% of travelers want to leave destinations better than they found them and 73% want their spending to benefit local communities (32,000 travelers, 34 countries). <https://news.booking.com/bookingcoms-2025-research-reveals-growing-traveler-awareness-of-tourism-impact-on-communities-both-at-home-and-abroad/> · accessed 2026-09-26
- 5. **MMGY Travel Intelligence**, Portrait of American Travelers, Summer 2026 Edition (as reported by the Family Travel Association), 2026-07-29. 52% of active leisure travelers used AI to plan trips (up 10 points year over year; ChatGPT 57%, Gemini 42% of AI users). Travelers are more selective: 3.5 expected trips and \$5,570 expected spend over 12 months; 55% are interested in event-tied travel. Survey of 4,371 U.S. adults, May 2026. <https://www.familytravel.org/2026/07/29/new-research-travelers-are-redefining-value/> · accessed 2026-09-26

LIMITATIONS

- All customer data is synthetic; relationships were designed, not observed.
- Segments are moderately separated (silhouette 0.226).
- Growth, whitespace, feasibility, credibility and defensibility scores are judgments, tested with sensitivity analysis.
- Stated willingness to pay overstates behavior; the adoption buffer is a simple correction.
- Competitor scores describe category archetypes, not companies.
- The financial model covers one year and assumes causal links that must be tested.
- Brand, experience and satisfaction baselines are assumptions until a tracker runs; creative is concept work.

EVIDENCE LABELS

EXTERNAL FACT cited source · **SYNTHETIC** generated data · **ASSUMPTION** analyst input · **JUDGMENT** scored with rationale · **SCENARIO** depends on assumptions · **RECOMMENDATION** what to do

FILES

Workbook: dashboard/brand_strategy_dashboard.xlsx (23 sheets, 1,476 formulas, zero errors) · Data: data/synthetic_customer_data.csv, data_dictionary.csv · Models: segmentation, opportunity scoring, financial, marketing, brand intelligence agent · Notebooks: analysis/*.ipynb